

Lay Up for Yourselves Treasure in Heaven

Matthew 7:24 is our pilot Scripture:

Therefore whosoever heareth these sayings of mine,
and doeth them,
I will liken him unto a wise man,
which built his house upon a rock:
And the rain descended,
and the floods came,
and the winds blew,
and beat upon that house;
and it fell not:
for it was founded upon a rock.

Once again, Jesus said a man is wise when he not only hears His sayings, but does them. He is like a man who built his house on a rock.

Then came the flood, hell or high water, and it could not shake the man's house because it was founded on the rock of doing Jesus' sayings.

Notice He did not say the flood would not come. He guaranteed you that it would. But along with that guarantee, no matter how bad it got, if you are a doer of Jesus' sayings, you have His personal guarantee that your house will not go down the river.

If you knew that by keeping His sayings your house would never go down the river, would it not behoove you to do them? How many of you would do them if you knew what they were?

As I said last night, I used to think His sayings were:

The works that I do shall ye do also;
and greater works than these shall ye do;
because I go unto my Father.

I like that saying. I am willing to do that one.

Then I found out the sayings He was talking about were sayings like:

Judge not,
that ye be not judged.

Love your enemy. Do good to them that hate you. Pray for those who spitefully use you.

Those are interesting sayings.

Tonight we back up and look at more of His sayings, the sayings that finally establish that house on the rock in such a way that it does not matter what hell thinks about you because there is nothing hell can do about it.

Matthew 6:19 says:

Lay not up for yourselves treasures upon earth,
where moth and rust doth corrupt,
and where thieves break through and steal:
But lay up for yourselves treasures in heaven,
where neither moth nor rust doth corrupt,
and where thieves do not break through nor steal:
For where your treasure is,
there will your heart be also.

This is very interesting, because as the chapter progresses, Jesus says we do not have to take any thought that says, "What are we going to eat?" or "What are we going to wear?"

He said your heavenly Father knows you have need of these things. Then He gave the classic instruction:

Seek ye first the kingdom of God,
and his righteousness;
and all these things shall be added unto you.

In this instruction, He said I do not have to take any thought for what I am going to eat or what I am going to wear.

How could I even consider laying any of my treasures up into heaven if I had no more than what it took to buy my food and clothes?

He is saying that as new creation, born-again, born-from-above Christians, we are capable of much more than believing just for what we eat and what we wear. He said you do not even have to occupy yourself with that.

If I did not have more than I eat and more than I wear, what would I have to lay up as treasures in heaven?

When He says to lay your treasures up in heaven, He says:

For where your treasure is,
there will your heart be also.

I have found out on the road of hard knocks that a man will put his treasure where his heart is. Where a man's heart functions, that is where he will put his treasure.

When a man has totally given his heart to the kingdom of God, and by heart I mean the center of the entire spectrum of existence, spirit, soul, and body, you do not even have to ask that man where his treasure is.

There are a lot of millionaires who give because somehow in their tax returns the giving benefits them. But if you took their money away and made giving no benefit to them, do you think they would still give if they did not reap some final benefit from a tax shelter or something else?

No. Most of them would not.

Jesus is saying that if your treasure is not in the kingdom of God, your heart is not. If your heart is not there, your treasure automatically will not be. But if your treasure is there, your heart will be in the center of the kingdom of God.

At least we know this: if my heart is in the center of the kingdom of God, it is not misplaced in the things the Gentiles seek after. If my treasure is in the kingdom of God, then my heart is in God's hands because He has the very part of me where the entrance of His Word brings light.

More than anything else in my existence at this point, I want my heart in the total operation of God.

It is disturbing to find out that if my treasure is not there, I can talk any kind of show I want. I can stand up and praise. I can worship. I can project any kind of front I want. But if my treasure is not in the kingdom of God, neither is the motivation and direction of my entire existence.

Matthew 6:22 says:

The light of the body is the eye:
if therefore thine eye be single,
thy whole body shall be full of light.

God, I love the way Jesus talked. He used natural things to illustrate spiritual applications.

My natural eyes let light into my body. My entire being is illuminated because these two physical organs let light into my body. I can cross this room without running into anything, and you can give me a sewing needle and a tiny thread, and I can thread it.

My entire body is full of light. Everything my body does is illuminated through these two physical organs.

But in the middle of a teaching on finances, Jesus makes this statement. What is He talking about in the realm of the Spirit?

If I lay my treasures up in heaven, it is because my heart has joined itself as one with the operation of the kingdom of God. The priority of my motivations is to see the kingdom of God expedited to the ends of this earth at any personal cost.

If He has my treasure, He has my heart. Then the light of the body is the eye. In the same way physical eyes light the operation of my entire being, the Holy Spirit moves in and begins to illuminate my spirit with everything Jesus is to me in the kingdom of God.

My seeking of Him and His righteousness becomes a reality because I am illuminated, because my spirit is in His hands, because the entire operation of my being is.

Take your finances out of the kingdom of God, and you can talk any good show you want. You have cut yourself off from His divine flow of revelation knowledge. He is not going to support someone who is supporting something else when eternal damnation and salvation as a precious jewel have been laid into your hands.

Let me tell you why unbelief is so powerful. It has stopped more of you than you can shake a stick at. You have been neutralized, and the sickening part is that you do not even know who did it.

God has legally limited Himself to the operation of His power through the body of Christ.

When He said:

| All things are possible to him that believeth.

Then the limit is off.

But since God has limited Himself to operation through the body of Christ, He said:

| How shall they hear without a preacher?
| And how shall they preach,
| except they be sent?

Millions of people around the world do not go to hell because God led them there. They go to hell because nobody stopped them.

Yet God has legally held Himself to His operation through His body. When your unbelief steps up, it is almost like a sacrilegious slap in the face, because through the precious blood of Jesus He has given it all.

That is why, to a man who believes, God will take the limit off, and He will do it gladly.

There was a time when I was having trouble loving God's people. I was very young. I thought everybody would treat me like I treated them. I thought I would sow to them the way I wanted them to treat me, and they would treat me that way.

They did not.

I was deceived and hurt as a young minister. I started asking God, "Those people You gave me, I want to give them back, like Moses did. He did not want them either."

I have found out since then that the people were not my problem. I was. It was me.

People are going to be the same when Jesus comes. If I am going to minister to their needs, which is exactly what those are, then I have to learn how to operate like Jesus operated.

Do you want to know why a rapist, a murderer, a whoremonger, or an adulterer is just as righteous as you are when he is bathed in the blood of Jesus?

It is because the extent of the damnable torment and punishment that came on that person was allowed to be laid on Jesus in its fullness. He was consumed from the inside out by your sin and mine when the chastisement of our peace was laid upon Him in punishment.

If Jesus died enough for you to go to hell in your place, then who are you?

You must be something else in deity if the King of kings, Jesus Christ Himself, would go to hell in your place.

This old boy is not touching you anymore with a ten-foot pole. If He loved you enough to die for you, I am not going to judge you anymore.

When I found myself gazing into the mouth of hell, I made up my mind that anything I could ever do to prevent people from going there, I would do. This became the motivation of my entire being. This is where I placed my heart.

When I placed my heart there, that is where my treasure went.

Matthew 6:22 says:

If therefore thine eye be single,
thy whole body shall be full of light.

If your whole heart and motivation are singly fastened on the propagation of the kingdom of God, your whole body will be full of light.

Verse 23 says:

But if thine eye be evil,
thy whole body shall be full of darkness.
If therefore the light that is in thee be darkness,
how great is that darkness!

Do you want to cut yourself off from the revelation knowledge of God? Do you want to cut yourself off from His illumination?

Take your treasure out of His kingdom, and whether you know it or not, you have cut yourself off from the illumination, the light of the body, the eye, and the inflow of revelation knowledge.

He is not going to give you illumination and revelation of precious things that are not a part of you.

Luke 16:8 says:

And the lord commended the unjust steward,
because he had done wisely:
for the children of this world
are in their generation wiser
than the children of light.

Although he commended the unjust steward, he still called him a child of this world and separated him from you and me, calling us children of light.

Even though he was commended, he was still called a child of darkness. The way Jesus differentiated between that child of darkness and us, the children of light, is that He called him wiser than us.

That is disturbing to me.

The teaching of the unjust steward says there was a certain rich man who had an unjust steward. He was called unjust because he was caught wasting his rich man's goods.

When he was called before the rich man to give account, the rich man said, "How is this that I hear of you? Give an account of your stewardship, for I am terminating it."

The steward remedied his problem by going to the debtors of the rich man. One debtor owed the rich man a hundred measures of wheat. Another owed him a hundred measures of oil.

The unjust steward went to both of them and said, "How much do you owe my rich man?" They told him, and he said, "Give me your bill." Then he canceled part of their debt against the rich man.

This makes me know the unjust steward had the power of attorney in the name of his rich man to cancel debts.

Later, those debtors against the rich man whose debts were canceled received that unjust steward into their houses. For this, Jesus called that unjust steward wise.

Why?

Because he was wise enough to use the power in money to ensure a final dwelling place by canceling the debt of men against the rich man.

Luke 16:8 says:

The children of this world
are in their generation wiser
than the children of light.

But Jesus will not leave us unwise.

Verse 9 says:

And I say unto you,
Make to yourselves friends
of the mammon of unrighteousness;
that, when ye fail,
they may receive you
into everlasting habitations.

He says to the children of light, "Make to yourselves friends by using the power that is in temporary money, the mammon of unrighteousness, so that when your stewardship on this earth over temporary possessions comes to an end, they may receive you into everlasting habitations."

That verse irritated me for seven years.

When Jesus turns to you and me and makes a statement that will make us wiser than the children of darkness, it would behoove us to listen.

He says, "Dave Roberson, make to yourself friends by using the power in money. When your temporary rule as a steward over the money fails, they will receive you into an everlasting habitation."

I said, "God, who is going to receive me?"

If you understood the parable, you would understand this. If I am the steward, the child of light on this earth, then God my Father is the rich man. The people indebted to the rich man are the entire world, sold to bondage and slavery to sin, put into debt against God by the sin question, a debt they could not pay.

As God's steward on this earth, He calls me wise because I use the power in temporary money, the power of attorney in the name of Jesus, to cancel people's debt against God, which is the sin question.

Every person's debt against God that I cancel through the proper use of money becomes treasure laid into an eternal habitation that is going to receive me on the day I walk into heaven.

Every person's sin question against God that you cancel through the proper use of that temporary stuff called money is treasure in heaven.

It pleased God in this natural realm to give us faith. It pleased Him to lay our poverty on Jesus and redeem us so it gives us open access to everything God has.

He has called me His steward. He has called you His steward. Every person you get born again, every person whose debt against God is canceled by your proper use of the power in money, will receive you into an everlasting habitation.

What a revelation, to know that temporary stuff such as money purchases an eternal reward for every person born again.

The day you enter the kingdom of heaven, they are all going to receive you as the treasure you laid up in heaven. They may bathe your feet in tears and wipe them with their hair in gratitude that you properly used money to cancel their debts.

Your treasure was laid up in heaven because your heart said, "Although we exist here in this temporary earth and life is like a vapor, hell or high water, there is not anything else."

In the short seventy years you live, if God does not have you in the total direction of your existence, if He does not have your heart, then we are dealing with eternal damnation and eternal salvation while your heart is somewhere else.

Everyone you pull out of hell is for eternity. Every person's debt that is canceled by your proper use of the power in money will stand as treasure in heaven because your heart was placed in the kingdom of God, and your treasure was busy canceling debts.